

**Dan Egan**

Chapters 9–10

WEEK 2 · WED 23 SEP

WATER QUESTION

If your taps stopped running, what would you miss first?

A hot shower after practice.
Also just being able to not think about water at all.

ARCHIVING What is here? Facts, ideas, style highlights.

Ch 9 - Mich-Huron record low 2013, ~6.5 ft below the 1980s high (p.280). Wetter than usual and still low. Less ice > warmer water > more evaporation. Superior ice cover down 76% 1973-2011 (p.282). Plus the drain: St Clair dredging lowered the lakes ~1.5 ft (p.289). Army Corps built a model, not the fix. Then up 3+ ft 2013-2015, biggest 2-yr rise on record (p.296).
Ch 10 - whitefish learn to eat mussels + gobies (p.302). Huron alewives crash, native fish come back, lake trout breed wild again (p.305).
STYLE: 'not a story about climate change. It's a story about climate changed' (p.281)

ANALYZING What does it mean? Who cares, who doesn't, who should care?

Two causes and people pick the one that suits them. Muter blames dredging; Pollack says people who deny climate change still want govt to 'engineer something' (p.294-295). Who cares: marinas, Georgian Bay owners, freighters (270 tons less cargo per inch lost, p.298). Who doesn't: whoever did the dredging. Who should: the 40 million in the basin (p.299). Ch 10 feels hopeful, but Tanner calls walleye 'like bringing in a wet sock' (p.317). Who are the lakes being managed for?

EXTENDING What does this tell us about our world right here and now?

Roebber says swings of 8-10 ft could be coming (p.297). 2013-15 already did 3+. Van Herick: 'not even close to developing a governance system' (p.316).
If my taps stopped I would want someone in charge. In these chapters nobody is, and every fix waits for the next crisis.

DISCUSSION What helpful questions can we ask about this work?

Who gets to decide which fish belong in the lakes now?
Is 'let the lakes heal on their own' (p.316) a plan or giving up?
Why end the book on a fishing trip?

VOCABULARY WORDS

evaporation · dredging · alewife
adaptive management · thiamine

FEELINGS EVOKED

wants relief at last (the fish adapt),
then warmth at the very end. On me:
I liked it, then wondered why fishing.

